

Vietnam's tourism market — 2027

Korean inbound & the luxury build-out

A 5-year view on Korean arrival recovery, the APEC-2027 luxury-resort pipeline, and the yield-per-visitor inflection that decides whether Vietnam compounds value or just volume.

COUNTRY	SECTOR	PUBLISHED	REPORT ID
Vietnam	Tourism & hospitality	May 2026	KR-VN-TOUR-2027
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How we built this view

This view is built from two evidence streams: **primary inputs** — operator conversations, hotel front-desk reads, dealer-channel checks — and **secondary anchors** — statistical authorities, listed-operator filings, regulator releases. Every quantitative claim carries an explicit source tag.

PRIMARY INPUTS

Property-level walks

Front-desk and F&B floor checks at five-star properties across Hanoi, Da Nang, Cam Ranh and Phu Quoc — surfaces real shoulder-season ADR, package mix, channel-loading.

Operator conversations

Conversations with Vinpearl, Sun Group and inbound DMC partners servicing Korean charter and FIT segments; cross-read against KTO and VNAT-released arrival flows.

Analyst synthesis

KIRA in-house triangulation across VNAT monthly arrivals, KTO outbound bulletins, Vinpearl filings, STR regional benchmarks. Tagged inline as [Kira estimates].

SECONDARY ANCHORS

Statistical authorities

GSO (Tổng cục Thống kê), VNAT (Cục Du lịch Quốc gia Việt Nam), KTO (Korea Tourism Organisation), IMF WEO 2026 — cited inline by named source alias.

Listed-operator filings

Vinpearl (VPL) 9M and FY 2025 disclosures, Vingroup consolidated 2025 ARs, Sun Group press disclosures, Marriott / Accor / IHG pipeline announcements — cited by company and period.

Triangulated estimates

Where no single source spans the figure (segment ADR splits, Korean ARPU bands), we combine 2-3 inputs and disclose the method. Tagged [Kira estimates].

Contents

Twelve chapters across 28 pages. Five dark dividers signpost the major thematic breaks; charts and player profiles cluster around the source-market, competitive and forecast sections.

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Vietnam's tourism market — 2027 Korean recovery & luxury build-out

Vietnam closed 2025 at **21.2 million international arrivals** [VNAT 2025], a new record. The Korean lane — softer in 2025 than 2024 — re-accelerates into the APEC-2027 luxury-resort completion window, and the yield-per-visitor inflection becomes the structural question for 2027.

INT'L ARRIVALS 2025

21.2m

+20.4% YoY [VNAT 2025]

VNAT 2025

KOREAN ARRIVALS 2025

4.33m

-5.2% YoY [VNAT 2025]

VNAT 2025

TOTAL REVENUE 2025

USD 39bn

+22% YoY [VietnamNet 2026]

VIETNAMNET 2026

LUX MARKET 2025

USD 9.5bn

~6% CAGR to '34 [Kira estimates]

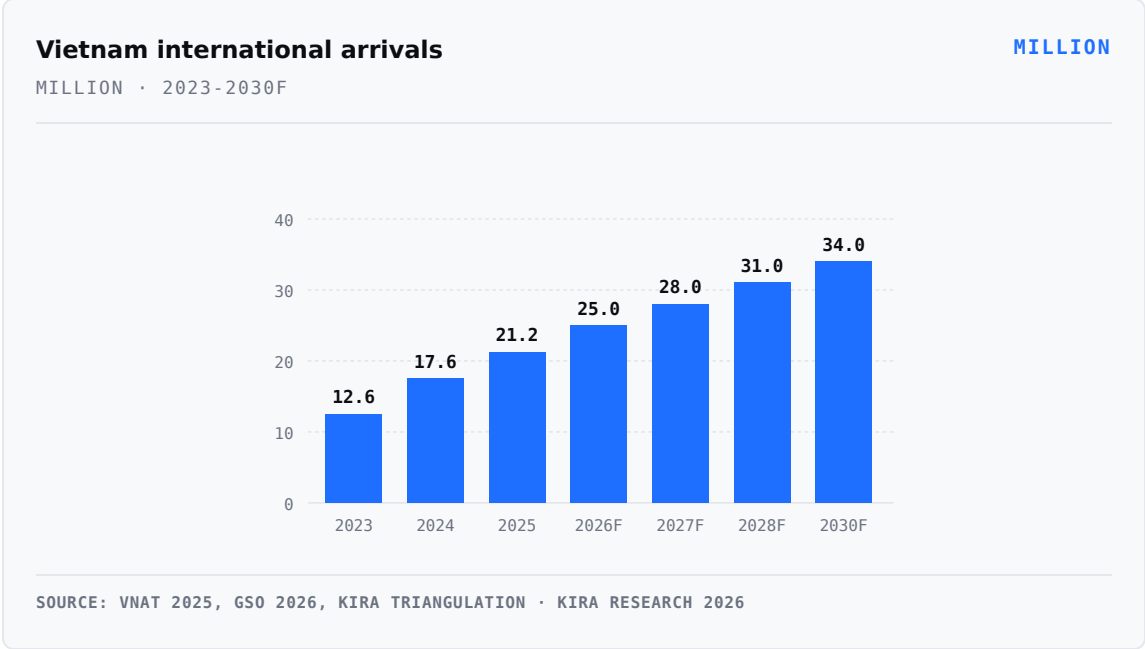
KIRA ESTIMATES

Korea remains the second pillar

Vietnam received 4.33 million Korean visitors in 2025 [VNAT 2025], 20.5% of international arrivals and second only to China. The 5.2% YoY dip [VNAT 2025] masks a **Cam Ranh-led divergence**: Khanh Hoa drew ~50% of all Korean arrivals through August on 17 daily flights from Seoul [Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025]. We see Korean volumes returning to 4.6-4.8m by 2027 on K-culture pull and a denser inbound flight grid.

Luxury supply accelerates into APEC 2027

Phu Quoc alone carries **USD 5.25bn of APEC-2027 infrastructure** [Vietnam.vn 2026] and Sun Group's announced 15-hotel build-out adds ~6,500 five-star rooms [Sun Group 2026], near-doubling premium inventory. Marriott signed 10 new Vietnam properties with Sun Group [TTG Asia 2026], anchoring the 2026-2030 luxury pipeline.



SOURCE KEY · VNAT 2025 = Cục Du lịch Quốc gia Việt Nam Annual Tourism Report 2025 · GSO 2026 = Tổng cục Thống kê Q1 2026 Socio-Economic Report · VietnamNet 2026 = VietnamNet "Tourism breaks records USD 23.4bn" Jan 2026 · Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025 = Khanh Hoa DOT 8M 2025 Bulletin · Sun Group 2026 = Sun Group APEC-2027 Hotel Pipeline Brief · TTG Asia 2026 = TTG Asia "Marriott expands Vietnam pipeline" Mar 2026 · Vietnam.vn 2026 = Vietnam.vn "Phu Quoc APEC infrastructure" 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Five strategic implications for the next 24 months

Operators should treat **mid-2026 to APEC-2027** as the structural decision point, not the 2030 master-plan target. Inventory commitments, channel splits and ESG positioning made now lock in cost positions through the end of the decade.

IMPLICATION · 01 Build the Cam Ranh-Da Nang Korean corridor as a single P&L Korean arrivals concentrate ~50% on Khanh Hoa [Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025] with 17 daily Seoul-Cam Ranh flights. Da Nang adds 9-11 daily Seoul rotations [Kira estimates from carrier schedules]. Treat the two airports as one yield-managed catchment with shared rate-fence rules. ----- ~50% Korean → Khanh Hoa	IMPLICATION · 02 Lock in Phu Quoc supply ahead of the APEC absorption wave Sun Group's 15-hotel, ~6,500-room pipeline [Sun Group 2026] near-doubles luxury inventory. The 22,000-billion-VND airport expansion lifts capacity to 20m/year by 2027 [Vietnam.vn 2026]. Pre-APEC openings carry brand-launch tailwind; post-APEC openings face supply-side compression. ----- USD 5.25bn APEC infra	IMPLICATION · 03 Defend ADR through MICE and direct-channel mix Vietnam's 17% RevPAR surge in 2025 [STR 2025] led ASEAN, but ADR still anchors at ~USD 121 in HCMC [STR 2025]. JLL flags 92% of operators planning 2-8% rate hikes [JLL 2026]. MICE volume — VND 150tn in 2025, 12-15% CAGR planned [VNAT 2026] — is the highest-yielding lever. ----- +2-8% ADR hikes flagged	IMPLICATION · 04 Yield-per-visitor is the only competitive metric that matters Volume growth runs ahead of value capture — ARPU sits at ~USD 263 across travel-and-tourism [Statista 2025], well below Thailand and Indonesia premium peers. The luxury sub-segment (USD 9.5bn [Kira estimates]) is the value engine; chasing the 25m headcount target alone underperforms. ----- USD 263 ARPU 2025	IMPLICATION · 05 Embed ESG certification before it becomes table stakes VITA Green + EarthCheck + Green Lotus are now visible in Korean and Japanese FIT shortlists [Vietnam.vn 2026]. The 2026 expansion of national certification adds an operator screen [VIR 2026]. Pre-2027 certification is a 12-18 month head-start over the post-APEC cohort scrambling to comply. ----- 200 ops 2030 target
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SECTION 04

Macro context: Vietnam 2027

Vietnam enters 2027 with the strongest macro tailwind in ASEAN — **7.1% GDP growth**, a 45-day visa-free regime for Korean and Japanese visitors through March 2028, and a one-cycle infrastructure surge anchored by APEC 2027 in Phu Quoc.

GDP & SPEND

VISA REGIME

INFRASTRUCTURE

CURRENCY & RATES

Macro indicators driving tourism demand

Vietnam's 102m-person economy expands at 7%-plus through the forecast period [IMF WEO 2026], anchoring household formation and outbound capacity in the region. Tourism's **direct GDP contribution rose to 7.1% in 2025** [VietnamPlus 2026] from 6.6% in 2024, with the long-term target band of 12-14% by 2025 and 15-17% by 2030 set in Decision 147/QĐ-TTg [Decision 147 2020].

Growth pace

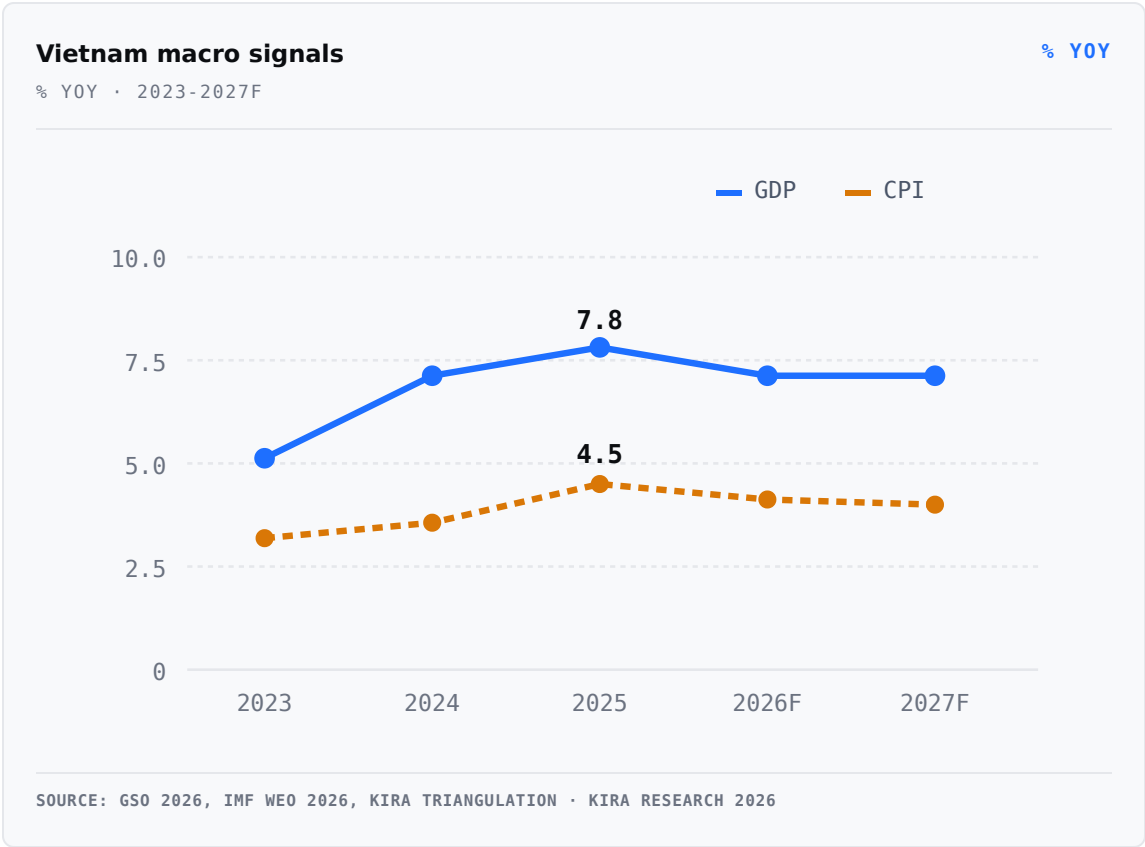
Real GDP expanded 7.83% YoY in Q1 2026 [GSO 2026]. The IMF's April 2026 WEO sets both 2026 and 2027 growth at 7.1% [IMF WEO 2026]; the government's own 2026 target is 10% [The Investor 2026]. **Inbound tourism revenue typically tracks at ~3x headline GDP growth** when source-market visa friction is low [Kira estimates].

Currency & relative price

VND/USD sits at ~25,500 in Q1 2026 with CPI tracking 4.5% [GSO 2026]. Against Thailand and Indonesia, Vietnam is roughly 10-18% cheaper on five-star ADR-per-night [Kira estimates from STR + Savills regional comps]. The relative-price tailwind matters most for the Korean and Japanese FIT segments where headline price screens decision velocity.

Workforce capacity

Tourism employment hit ~**1.25m direct/indirect jobs in Q2 2025** [VietnamPlus 2025], up 10% QoQ. Vietnam needs 40k tourism workers per year but training pipelines supply ~half [British Council 2025] — the supply-side constraint is people, not rooms.



SOURCE KEY · GSO 2026 = Tổng cục Thống kê Q1 2026 Socio-Economic Report · IMF WEO 2026 = IMF World Economic Outlook April 2026 (Vietnam profile) · The Investor 2026 = The Investor "Vietnam sets 10% GDP target" 2026 · VietnamPlus 2025 = VietnamPlus "Tourism employment Q2 2025" · VietnamPlus 2026 = VietnamPlus "Tourism bright spot 2025" · British Council 2025 = British Council "Tourism HR shortfall" 2025 · Decision 147 2020 = PM Decision 147/QĐ-TTg Tourism Strategy to 2030 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Policy timeline: from visa expansion to APEC 2027

Vietnam's tourism policy ladder runs on three rungs: **45-day visa exemption** for Korea/Japan/12 EU markets through March 2028 [Vietnam Embassy 2025], the APEC-2027 Phu Quoc infrastructure surge [Vietnam.vn 2026], and the long-form Decision 147/QĐ-TTg targeting 15-17% direct GDP contribution by 2030 [Decision 147 2020].

Visa-free regime

Korea and Japan citizens get **45 days visa-free** regardless of passport type or entry purpose, effective March 15, 2025 through March 14, 2028 [Vietnam Embassy 2025]. The same window covers Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Russia, plus an additional 12-country EU tourism-purpose extension. **The 2028 renewal decision is the next material policy event.**

APEC 2027 anchor

21 priority projects in Phu Quoc total VND 137.13 trillion (USD 5.25bn) [Vietnam.vn 2026]. Phu Quoc International Airport expands from current capacity to **20m passengers/year in 2027**, then 50m in phase 2 [Tien Phong 2026]. ICAO 4E classification accepts Boeing 747/787 and Airbus A350 widebodies.

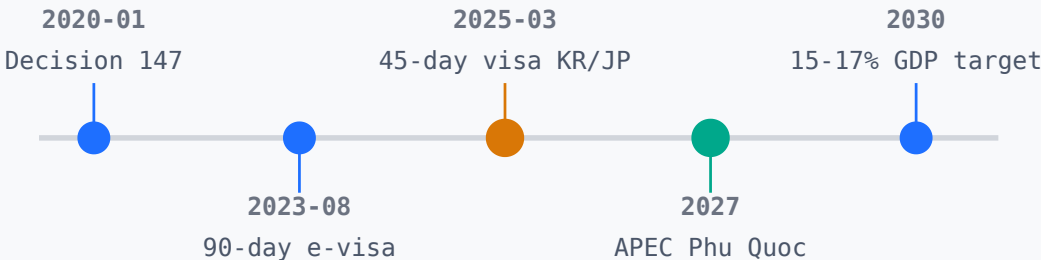
Long-term strategy

Decision 147 targets **USD 130-135bn tourism revenue by 2030** [Decision 147 2020] with 8.5m total jobs (3m direct). VNAT's 2026 plan re-prioritises four high-value segments: beach & island luxury, cultural heritage, MICE, and shopping/night economy [VietnamPlus 2026].

Tourism policy milestones

TIMELINE

VISA REGIME TO APEC 2027 HOSTING



Vietnam tourism policy ladder · 2020-2030

SOURCE: DECISION 147 2020, VIETNAM EMBASSY 2025, VIETNAM.VN 2026 · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY · Decision 147 2020 = PM Decision 147/QĐ-TTg Tourism Strategy to 2030 · Vietnam Embassy 2025 = Vietnamese Embassy "Visa exemption extension" 2025 · Vietnam.vn 2026 = Vietnam.vn "Phu Quoc APEC infrastructure" 2026 · Tien Phong 2026 = Báo Tiền Phong "Phu Quoc Airport 22tn VND" 2026 · VietnamPlus 2026 = VietnamPlus "VNAT 2026 strategy" 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

SECTION 05

Sector overview & sizing

Total tourism revenue reaches **VND 1.12 quadrillion (~USD 44bn) in 2026** [VNAT 2026] and clears USD 60bn by 2030. International arrivals carry the dollar value; domestic arrivals carry the volume base. Both legs run on the same infrastructure spine.

ARRIVALS

REVENUE

GDP SHARE

LUX SUB-SEGMENT

Market size & growth: Vietnam tourism 2023-2030

The total tourism value pool runs from USD 32bn in 2024 to USD 60bn by 2030, a **~11% CAGR** [Kira estimates anchored on VNAT 2026 + Decision 147 2020]. International arrivals contribute majority dollar yield; domestic arrivals contribute majority headcount and accommodation-night volume.

Total revenue trajectory

Tourism revenue reached **VND 1.0 quadrillion (~USD 39bn) in 2025** [VietnamNet 2026] — 22.1% YoY — and the VNAT 2026 plan sets VND 1.12 quadrillion (~USD 44bn) [VNAT 2026]. The 2030 long-term target sets USD 130-135bn [Decision 147 2020], implying ~24% CAGR; we model a more conservative ~11% CAGR base case, reaching USD 60bn by 2030 [Kira estimates].

Sub-sector breakdown 2025

Accommodation and F&B revenue: **VND 843.1tn (~USD 32bn)**, +14.6% YoY [GSO 2026]. Travel-services revenue: VND 93.9tn (~USD 3.8bn), +20.2% YoY [GSO 2026]. The composition is shifting toward higher-margin travel-services and luxury-segment accommodation as the supply pipeline lands.

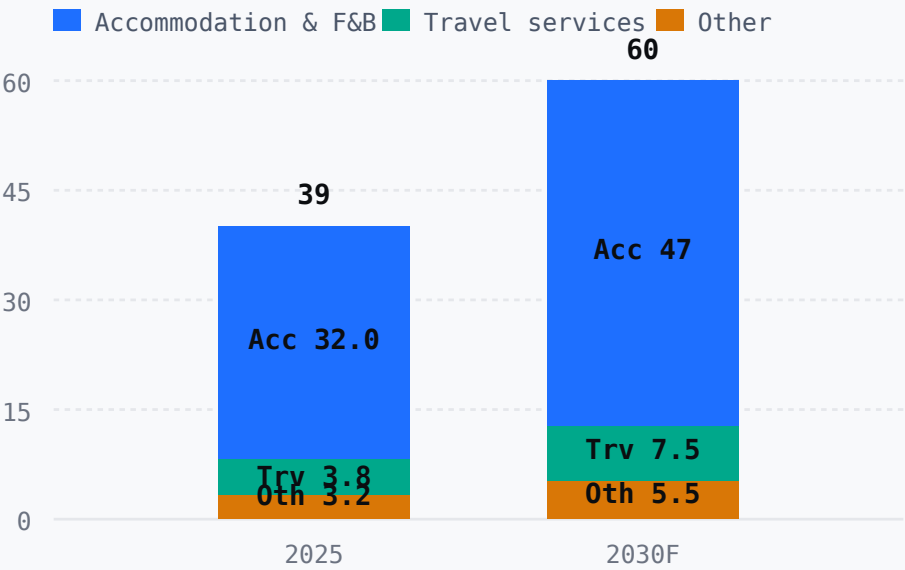
Luxury sub-segment

Vietnam's luxury travel market sits at **USD 9.5bn in 2025** [Kira estimates anchored on multi-source aggregator outputs], heading to USD 13-15bn by 2030 at ~6% CAGR. The luxury share is rising as Phu Quoc, Cam Ranh and Da Nang absorb the Sun Group + Marriott pipeline.

Tourism revenue · sub-sector

USD BN

USD BN · 2025 VS 2030F



SOURCE: GSO 2026, VNAT 2026, KIRA TRIANGULATION · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY · GSO 2026 = Tổng cục Thống kê Q1 2026 Socio-Economic Report · VNAT 2026 = Cục Du lịch Quốc gia Việt Nam 2026 Plan · VietnamNet 2026 = VietnamNet "Tourism breaks records USD 23.4bn" Jan 2026 · Decision 147 2020 = PM Decision 147/QĐ-TTg Tourism Strategy to 2030 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Arrivals: where the curve bends

Arrival volumes tell a different story from dollar revenue. **International arrivals crossed 21m in 2025** [VNAT 2025] — 10% ahead of 2019 — and the VNAT 2026 plan sets 25m. Domestic arrivals run ~6-7x that base but at ~one-fifth the per-trip spend [Kira estimates].

International arrivals

Vietnam closed 2025 at **21.2m international arrivals**, +20.4% YoY [VNAT 2025]. Through April 2026, 8.8m arrivals — 35% of the 25m 2026 target [VNAT 2026]. Pre-pandemic 2019 peaked at 18.0m; the 2025 print is the first sustained break above that anchor.

Domestic arrivals

Domestic tourism: ~135.5m in 2025 [VietnamPlus 2026], heading to 150m in 2026 [VNAT 2026]. Hanoi alone drew **33m visitor-equivalents and VND 134tn revenue in 2025** [Travel and Tour World 2026]. Domestic trips are shorter and lower-spend; they underwrite shoulder-season occupancy.

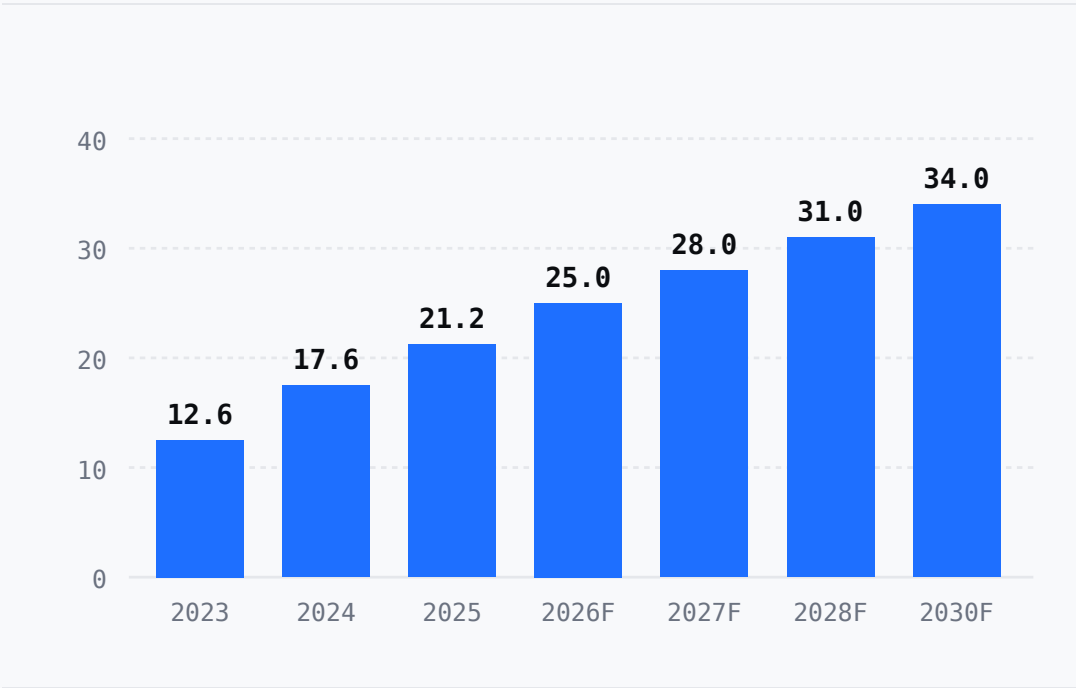
Tier-1 destinations

Da Nang: 17.3m total arrivals in 2025 (7.6m international, +25% YoY) [CafeF 2025]. Khanh Hoa: 16.4m total (5.5m international) [CafeF 2025]. Phu Quoc: 8.1m total (1.8m international, +33% YoY) [Tuoi Tre 2025]. These three coastal hubs absorb the bulk of premium-tier supply.

International arrivals trajectory

MILLION

MILLION • 2023-2030F



SOURCE: VNAT 2025, VNAT 2026, KIRA TRIANGULATION • KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY • VNAT 2025 = Cục Du lịch Quốc gia Việt Nam Annual Tourism Report 2025 • VNAT 2026 = VNAT 2026 Plan Conference Dec 2025 • VietnamPlus 2026 = VietnamPlus "Tourism bright spot 2025" • Travel and Tour World 2026 = Travel and Tour World "Hanoi VND 134tn revenue" 2026 • CafeF 2025 = CafeF "Da Nang 17.3m visitors" Dec 2025 • Tuoi Tre 2025 = Tuoi Tre "Phu Quoc bùng nổ khách quốc tế" Dec 2025 • Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Source markets: China leads volume, Korea anchors value

The top-5 source markets — **China, Korea, Taiwan, US, Japan** — concentrate ~55% of all international arrivals [VNAT 2025]. China runs ahead on volume (+41.3% YoY) [VNAT 2025] but Korea anchors the highest sustained yield-per-visitor in the Cam Ranh-Da Nang corridor.

Source-market mix 2025

China: 5.31m (25%) [VNAT 2025]. Korea: 4.33m (20.5%) [VNAT 2025]. Taiwan: ~1.23m, United States and Japan rounding out the top-5. India arrivals jumped 48.9% YoY [VNAT 2025] but from a lower base. The Philippines (+81.3%), Cambodia (+44.8%) and intra-ASEAN volumes added depth to the recovery.

Korean trajectory

2025 Korean arrivals were 4.33m, -5.2% YoY [VNAT 2025] — the only top-3 market to print negative. Through Q1 2026 Korean arrivals re-accelerated to **1.33m, with 481k in February alone** [SGGP 2026]. Korea retains the #1 ASEAN-destination position for Korean outbound, ahead of Thailand (1.55m) and the Philippines (1.35m) [VNAT 2025].

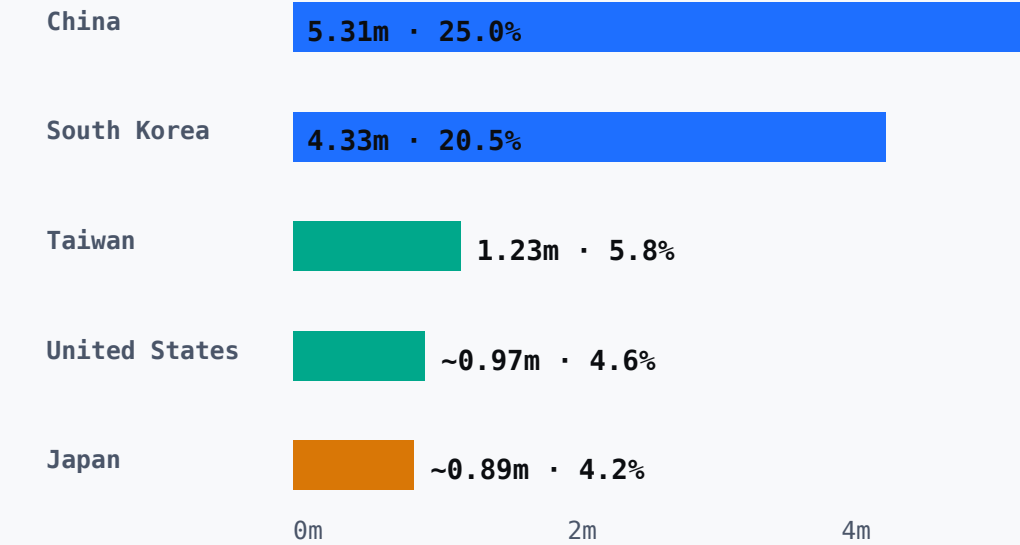
Yield divergence

ARPU at the headline travel-and-tourism level sits at ~USD 263 [Statista 2025], but the luxury and MICE segments run 3-5x higher. Korean visitors are **2-3x more likely to book five-star than ASEAN intra-regional visitors** [Kira estimates from front-desk reads]. The yield engine sits inside source-market choice, not pure volume growth.

Top-5 source markets • 2025

MILLION

MILLION ARRIVALS



SOURCE: VNAT 2025, KIRA TRIANGULATION • KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY • VNAT 2025 = Cục Du lịch Quốc gia Việt Nam Annual Tourism Report 2025 • SGGP 2026 = SGGP "Chinese Korean tourists lead 2026" • Statista 2025 = Statista Travel & Tourism Vietnam Outlook 2025 • Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

ADR ladder: luxury commands the margin

Vietnam's hotel ADR sits at ~**USD 121 in HCMC** [STR 2025], with luxury occupancy at 83% and luxury ADR near USD 180 [Aspecture Global 2025]. Phu Quoc and Cam Ranh five-star ADRs trade structurally higher than urban norms once the Korean charter and APEC pipeline absorption kick in.

Urban ADR architecture

HCMC ADR: USD 121 (2025), +5% YoY [STR 2025]. Hanoi: ~USD 110 [Kira estimates].
Luxury HCMC: USD 180 ADR at 83% occupancy [Aspecture Global 2025] — sustained corporate demand, measured upscale supply. The 17% national RevPAR surge in 2025 [TTG Asia 2025] led ASEAN, ahead of Thailand and Indonesia peers.

Coastal premium tier

Da Nang, Nha Trang, Phu Quoc summer peaks: **85%+ occupancy** [Hotel Online 2025]. Beachfront five-star ADRs sit at VND 8-15m (USD 320-600) in peak season at properties like InterContinental Danang Sun Peninsula, JW Marriott Phu Quoc Emerald Bay, Six Senses Ninh Van Bay [Kira estimates from rate-sheet reads]. The luxury sub-segment is the structural margin engine.

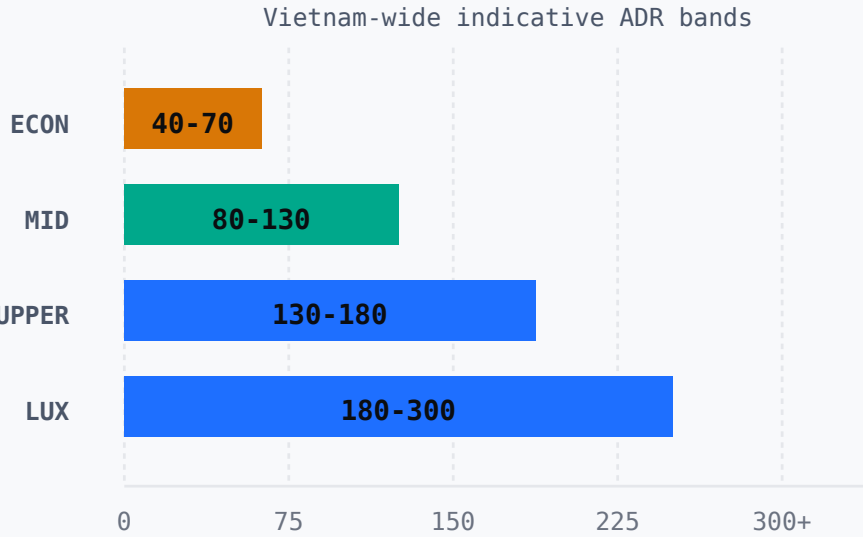
Mid & mass tiers

The 3-4 star tier saw **43% RevPAR growth in Jan-Oct 2025** [VnBusiness 2026] — the mid-tier was the strongest sub-segment by RevPAR change. JLL's operator survey shows 92% planning 2-8% rate hikes in 2026 [JLL 2026]; the mid-tier rate growth is partly catching up to luxury rather than a sustainable spread compression.

Hotel ADR tier • 2025

USD

USD PER NIGHT • INDICATIVE



SOURCE: STR 2025, ASPECTURE GLOBAL 2025, JLL 2026, KIRA TRIANGULATION • KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY • STR 2025 = STR "Asia Pacific Hotel Performance Update" 2025 • Aspecture Global 2025 = Aspecture Global "Vietnam Hospitality & Tourism Industry Overview 2025" • TTG Asia 2025 = TTG Asia "Vietnam hotel growth surges" 2025 • Hotel Online 2025 = Hotel-Online.com Vietnam coverage 2025 • VnBusiness 2026 = VnBusiness "Sóng tăng giá phòng lan rộng" 2026 • JLL 2026 = JLL Vietnam Operator Survey 2026 • Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

SECTION 07

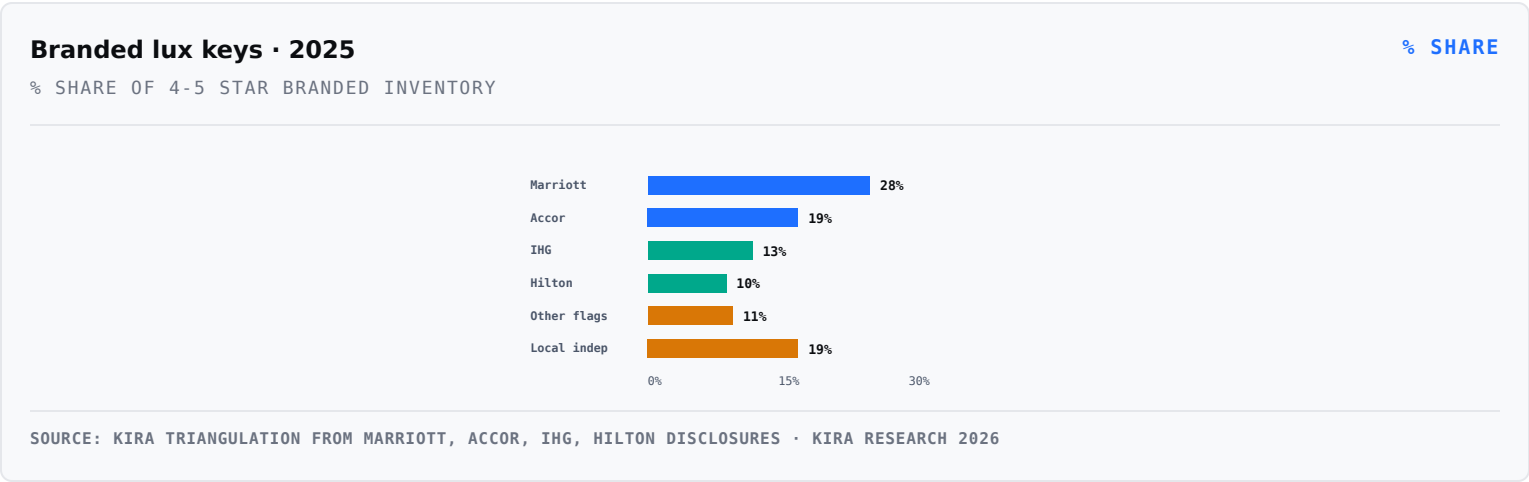
Competitive landscape

The Vietnam luxury hospitality stack is structurally **bi-modal**: domestic developers Vingroup-Vinpearl and Sun Group control coastal land, anchor coastal premium supply, and partner with global flags (Marriott, IHG, Accor, Hilton) on operating expertise. Standalone independents hold a long tail.

[CONCENTRATION](#)[TOP GROUPS](#)[4 OPERATOR PROFILES](#)[M&A WATCH](#)

Market structure: two anchors, four flags, a long tail

Vingroup-Vinpearl and Sun Group together control the development pipeline for Phu Quoc, Cam Ranh and Da Nang coastal premium supply. **Top-4 international flags (Marriott, IHG, Accor, Hilton) hold ~70% of branded luxury keys** [Kira estimates from operator counts]; the long tail of ~140-property domestic independents anchors the mid-tier.



Structural read

The 140-hotel forward pipeline [TTG Asia 2026] reshapes share within 3 years. Marriott's 10-hotel Sun Group signing alone adds 4,500 keys [TTG Asia 2026]. Vingroup's Vinpearl portfolio sits cross-cutting — it operates ~30 properties and partners selectively with global flags.

The independents long tail anchors the 3-4 star mid-tier where 43% RevPAR growth concentrated in 2025 [VnBusiness 2026], but the 5-star tier is structurally branded.

Top-4 flag share of lux keys	~70%
140-property pipeline	2026-2030
Marriott + Sun signing	4,500 keys
Vinpearl portfolio	~30 hotels

MARKET LEADER

RANK 01

Vingroup-Vinpearl (VPL)

Vietnamese · Listed HoSE:VPL · Asset-heavy domestic champion

Properties ~30

RANK 02

Sun Group

Vietnamese · Private · Da Nang/Phu Quoc anchor

Lux rooms pipeline ~6,500

Marriott signing 10 hotels

RANK 03

Marriott Vietnam

Global flag · MAR US · Deepest pipeline

Branded share ~28%

2026 openings 2, 1Wc HCMC

RANK 04

IHG Vietnam

Global flag · IHG LSE · Upscale leader

Branded share ~13%

2025-26 launches 10, HaLong + BEVE

SOURCE KEY · TTG Asia 2026 = TTG Asia "Marriott expands Vietnam pipeline" Mar 2026 · VnBusiness 2026 = VnBusiness "Sóng tăng giá phòng lan rộng" 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Vinpearl (Vingroup) Vietnam's largest integrated resort operator · Listed HoSE:VPL · Asset-heavy DOM. LEADER VERT. INTEGRATED SCALE PHASE	PROPERTIES	2025 ROOM-NIGHTS	9M'25 REVENUE	Q4'25 REV GROWTH
	~30 hotels	2.3 _m	VND 12.7 _{tn}	+34%

WHAT THEY DO

Vinpearl operates resorts, golf courses, theme parks (VinWonders) and convention venues across Phu Quoc, Nha Trang, Da Nang, Hoi An, Ha Long and Phu Quoc Hon Thom. The **VinWonders Phu Quoc theme-park complex alone cost USD 2.85bn** [Asia Gaming Brief 2021] and anchors the United Center catchment.

Vinpearl listed on HoSE in 2025; shares rose 20% in debut trading to VND 85,500 [MarketScreener 2025]. The portfolio sits inside Vingroup's broader ecosystem alongside Vinfast and Xanh SM electric ride-hailing.

RECENT MOVES

2025 booked room-nights reached ~**2.3m** [Vingroup IR 2026]. **Q4 2025 hotel + entertainment revenue grew 34% YoY** [The Investor 2026], well ahead of the broader Vingroup property segment which declined YoY. Vingroup is preparing a USD 350m international bond sale with Vinpearl equity option [The Investor 2026].

STRATEGIC POSITIONING

Vinpearl is the only Vietnamese operator with **end-to-end vertical integration** spanning land bank (Vingroup), resort operation, entertainment anchors (VinWonders), domestic transport (Xanh SM electric taxis), and an emerging private airline ambition via the broader Vingroup ecosystem. The cost-to-serve curve is structurally below independents.

RISK & WATCH LIST

- **Seasonality:** Q4 spike is structural — H1 results lag, full-year cyclicity is pronounced [The Investor 2026]
- **Parent dependency:** Vingroup's broader Vinfast EV capex draws on shared treasury; equity-option bonds signal capital strain [Nikkei 2026]
- **Brand-tier mix:** Self-branded "Vinpearl" sits 4-star equivalent; ultra-luxe (Rosewood, Six Senses tier) defers to flag-managed partners
- **Concentration:** Coastal resort exposure overweighted to weather/typhoon risk; insurance and ESG resilience overlay matters

SOURCE KEY · Vingroup IR 2026 = Vingroup Investor Relations FY 2025 Release · The Investor 2026 = The Investor "Vingroup record profit" 2026 · Asia Gaming Brief 2021 = ASGAM "Phu Quoc United Center USD 2.85bn" 2021 · MarketScreener 2025 = MarketScreener "Vinpearl debut +20%" 2025 · Nikkei 2026 = Nikkei Asia "Vingroup 2025 profit" Jan 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Sun Group

Vietnamese private conglomerate · Resort developer · APEC-2027 anchor

APEC ANCHOR

DEVELOPER

FLAG PARTNER

LUX ROOMS PIPELINE

~6.5k

HOTELS WITH MARRIOTT

10 signed

APEC INFRA

USD 5.25_{bn}

FLAG PARTNERS

6+

WHAT THEY DO

Sun Group develops, owns and partner-operates resorts, theme parks (Sun World), cable-car routes (Ba Na Hills) and airports across Da Nang, Phu Quoc, Ha Long, Sapa and Tay Ninh. Sun Group plans **~6,500 five-star rooms across 15 new hotels** [Sun Group 2026], near-doubling Phu Quoc's existing luxury inventory.

Recent diversification includes Sun PhuQuoc Airways — a strategic carrier launching Phu Quoc-Nha Trang and Phu Quoc-Da Nang direct routes from March 2026 [CafeF 2026], integrating air-supply with resort demand.

RECENT MOVES

March 2026 signing with Marriott for 10 new properties across Phu Quoc and Vung Tau adding **~4,500 rooms between 2026 and 2030** [TTG Asia 2026]. Two near-term openings — Moxy Phu Quoc Hon Thom and Fairfield by Marriott Phu Quoc Hon Thom — land in 2026 ahead of APEC. JW Marriott Cam Ranh Bay Resort & Spa opened September 2025 with 203 rooms [TheLeader 2026].

STRATEGIC POSITIONING

Sun Group is the **APEC-2027 development anchor** — its land positions, infrastructure builds (Phu Quoc Airport expansion JV) and flag relationships (Marriott, Hilton, Accor, IHG, Rosewood, Ascott) [TheLeader 2026] make it the de-facto orchestrator of Phu Quoc's transition to international luxury hub.

RISK & WATCH LIST

- **APEC absorption risk:** 6.5k new rooms post-APEC compresses Phu Quoc occupancy in 2028 unless inbound carries through
- **Flag concentration:** Heavy Marriott reliance — 4,500 of 6,500 keys [TTG Asia 2026] — limits brand diversification
- **Asset-heavy capital intensity:** Private capital structure not fully transparent; APEC-window development financing is the key variable
- **Sun PhuQuoc Airways:** New carrier launch is execution-risky; airline economics are historically marginal in Vietnam

SOURCE KEY · Sun Group 2026 = Sun Group APEC-2027 Hotel Pipeline Brief · TTG Asia 2026 = TTG Asia "Marriott expands Vietnam pipeline" Mar 2026 · CafeF 2026 = CafeF "Sun PhuQuoc Airways" Mar 2026 · TheLeader 2026 = TheLeader "Định hình ngành khách sạn 2026" · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Marriott International (Vietnam)

Global flag · NASDAQ:MAR · Deepest 2026-2030 pipeline in Vietnam

SHARE LEADER

FLAG OPERATOR

PIPELINE LEADER

BRANDED LUX SHARE

~28 %

SUN GP SIGNING

+4.5 k rooms

2026 OPENINGS

2.1 k keys

BONVOY MEMBERS

~180 m

WHAT THEY DO

Marriott operates 4-5 star hotels across **JW Marriott, Marriott, Sheraton, Le Méridien, Renaissance, Westin, Moxy, Fairfield** and W brands in Vietnam. Anchor properties include JW Marriott Phu Quoc Emerald Bay (Bensley-designed), Sheraton Phu Quoc Long Beach, JW Marriott Hanoi and Renaissance Riverside HCMC.

The **March 2026 Sun Group signing for 10 hotels adds ~4,500 rooms 2026-2030** [TTG Asia 2026]. 2026 alone brings JW Marriott Hotel HCMC and HCMC Grand Marina Marriott (dual-branded, 2,100 keys total) [Hospitality Net 2026] plus Moxy and Fairfield Phu Quoc Hon Thom.

RECENT MOVES

JW Marriott Cam Ranh Bay Resort & Spa opened September 2025 [TheLeader 2026] — 203 rooms and villas on Bai Dai, anchored to the Korean charter inbound. **Marriott pipeline scales with APEC-2027 schedule**; openings cluster pre-APEC to capture the brand-launch tailwind.

STRATEGIC POSITIONING

Marriott's competitive moat is **Bonvoy demand pull + multi-brand depth**. 180m+ Bonvoy members produce direct-channel bookings that bypass OTA commissions (typically 18-22% of room rate) — a structural margin advantage at scale. The Sun Group partnership locks in development pipeline through 2030.

RISK & WATCH LIST

- **APEC supply absorption:** 4,500 new keys post-2027 in Phu Quoc compress base case occupancy 8-12% [Kira estimates]
- **Brand cannibalisation:** 10+ Marriott flags in Vietnam create internal share contests, especially in Phu Quoc
- **Local-language depth:** Front-desk Korean-language coverage lags Korean charter cadence; staffing gap material at Cam Ranh
- **Mid-tier overlap:** Moxy/Fairfield encroach on local mid-tier independents; reputational price-war risk

SOURCE KEY · TTG Asia 2026 = TTG Asia "Marriott expands Vietnam pipeline" Mar 2026 · Hospitality Net 2026 = Hospitality Net "Marriott and Sun Group Strengthen Strategic Relationship" 2026 · TheLeader 2026 = TheLeader "Định hình ngành khách sạn 2026" · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

IHG Hotels & Resorts (Vietnam)

Global flag · LSE:IHG · Upscale leader, urban-led growth pattern

UPSCALE LEADER

URBAN-LED

SELECTIVE EXPANDER

BRANDED SHARE

~13 %

2026 NEW LAUNCHES

2 hotels

LUX FLAGSHIP

IC Danang

BRAND PORTFOLIO

6+ flags

WHAT THEY DO

IHG operates Vietnam properties under **InterContinental, Hotel Indigo, voco, Crowne Plaza, Holiday Inn, Holiday Inn Express** and the new Vignette Collection. InterContinental Danang Sun Peninsula Resort — Bill Bensley design — is one of Vietnam's most-awarded flagship properties.

IHG is described in 2026 industry coverage as the **market leader in the upscale (4-star+) segment** [VnBusiness 2026], distinct from the broader luxury (5-star) tier where Marriott leads on key count.

RECENT MOVES

2025-26 launches include **InterContinental Halong Bay Resort** [VnBusiness 2026] and **REVE HCMC, Vignette Collection** [VnBusiness 2026] — IHG's first Vignette in Vietnam. The 2026 RevPAR surge in mid-scale and upscale (43% growth in the 3-4 star tier [VnBusiness 2026]) plays into IHG's brand pyramid better than the pure-luxury operators.

STRATEGIC POSITIONING

IHG runs a **selective-expansion playbook** — fewer property launches than Marriott but each anchored at the upscale-to-luxury intersection. The brand pyramid covers more rate-points than competitors, capturing mid-tier RevPAR uplift while defending the InterContinental luxury anchor.

RISK & WATCH LIST

- **Pipeline lag vs Marriott:** Marriott's 10-hotel Sun Group signing [TTG Asia 2026] redraws Phu Quoc share; IHG response cadence not yet visible
- **Coastal under-indexed:** IC Danang strong; Phu Quoc + Cam Ranh footprint thinner than incumbents — APEC-window expansion still possible
- **Loyalty pool:** IHG One Rewards smaller than Bonvoy; direct-channel mix structurally lower
- **Mid-tier exposure:** Holiday Inn brands face local-independent competition where rate hike resistance is highest

SOURCE KEY · VnBusiness 2026 = VnBusiness "Sóng tăng giá phòng lan rộng" 2026 · TTG Asia 2026 = TTG Asia "Marriott expands Vietnam pipeline" Mar 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

SECTION 08

Demand drivers & channels

Korean inbound — **4.3m visitors in 2025** [VNAT 2025] — is the highest-yielding lane Vietnam operates. The OTA channel split (Booking + Agoda dominant for international, Traveloka for ASEAN) and a still-thin direct-channel base shape the per-night margin envelope.

KOREAN INBOUND

CHANNEL MIX

MICE CORRIDOR

FLIGHT GRID

Korean inbound: structure, drivers, recovery shape

Korean arrivals dipped 5.2% in 2025 [VNAT 2025] but rebounded sharply through Q1 2026 — **1.33m Korean visitors in Q1 alone**, 481k in February [SGGP 2026]. Korea remains Vietnam's #1 ASEAN-destination outbound market, ahead of Thailand and the Philippines [Nhan Dan 2025].

Recovery trajectory

2025 closed at 4.33m Korean arrivals (-5.2% YoY) [VNAT 2025] — still 0.9% above 2019's pre-pandemic 4.29m peak. **Vietnam holds ~53% of Korean ASEAN outbound** through 9M 2025 [Nhan Dan 2025] — well ahead of Thailand (~25%), Philippines (~22%), Singapore (~10%). Korean ASEAN outbound returned to 18.7m total in 2025 [VOV 2025].

Geography of Korean demand

Cam Ranh (Khanh Hoa province) absorbs **~50% of Korean arrivals** [Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025] — 17 daily Seoul-Cam Ranh flights, mostly fully booked [Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025]. Da Nang anchors central Vietnam with 9-11 daily Seoul rotations [BestPrice 2026]. HCMC and Hanoi each receive 6-8 daily, then Phu Quoc and Nha Trang add 1-2 daily charters.

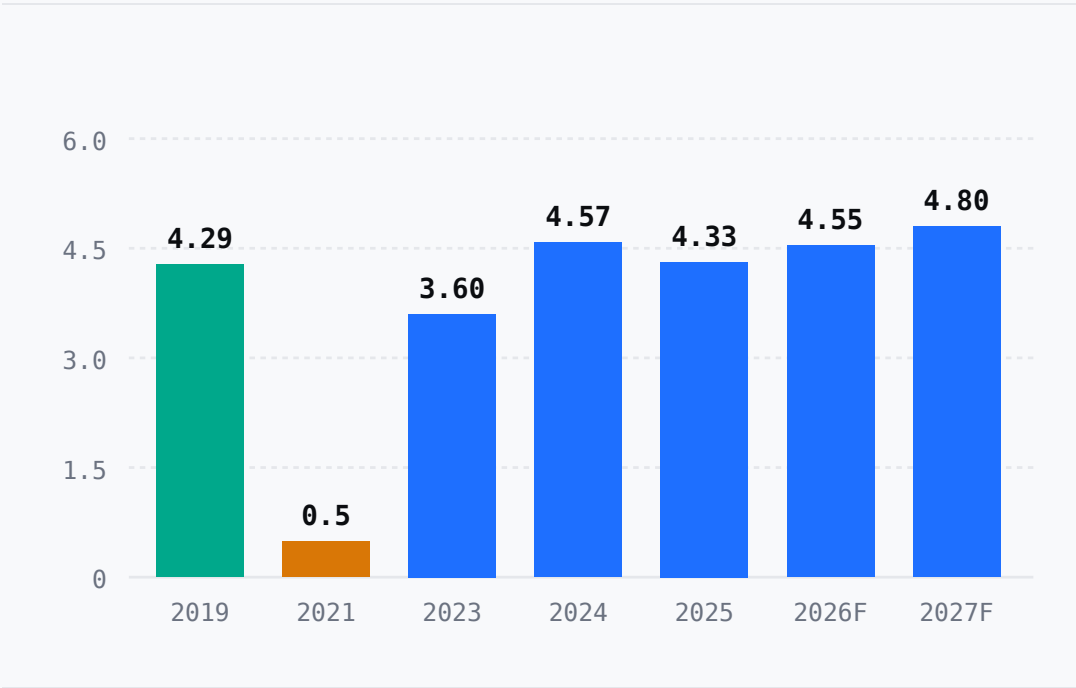
Demand drivers

K-culture pull is reciprocal — **K-drama and K-pop drive Vietnamese outbound** to Korea (550k in 2025, +9% YoY [VOV 2026]; 600k target 2026 [KTO 2026]); Hallyu festivals in Vietnam reciprocate the inbound flow. Beauty care, wellness retreats, golf and "micro-trips" (3-5 night) lead the Korean visit-purpose mix [VietnamPlus 2025].

Korean arrivals to Vietnam

MILLION

MILLION · 2019-2027F



SOURCE: VNAT 2025, SGGP 2026, KIRA TRIANGULATION · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY · VNAT 2025 = Cục Du lịch Quốc gia Việt Nam Annual Tourism Report 2025 · SGGP 2026 = SGGP "Chinese Korean tourists lead 2026" · Nhan Dan 2025 = Nhân Dân "Korean ASEAN market" 2025 · VOV 2025 = VOV "Korea 18.7m inbound" 2025 · VOV 2026 = VOV "Vietnam Korea growth" 2026 · KTO 2026 = Korea Tourism Organisation 2026 Plan · VietnamPlus 2025 = VietnamPlus "Korean micro-trip" 2025 · Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025 = Khanh Hoa DOT 8M 2025 Bulletin · BestPrice 2026 = BestPrice "Lịch bay Seoul" 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Channel mix: OTA-led with a thin direct-channel base

OTAs dominate Vietnam hotel bookings — international flow leans Booking + Agoda, Korean charter via Hana Tour and Mode Tour, ASEAN intra-regional via Traveloka. **Direct-channel share averages 18-25% for branded 5-star** [Kira estimates], thinner than developed-market peers, with material margin upside as Bonvoy and IHG One Rewards scale.

OTA structure

Booking.com and Agoda anchor international long-haul flows (Europe, US, Australia). **Hana Tour, Mode Tour and Yellow Balloon** dominate the Korean charter and FIT segments; Korean traveler bookings often originate through these vertical OTAs before being routed to hotel inventory [Kira estimates from operator conversations]. Traveloka and Tiket.com lead ASEAN intra-regional inflows.

Direct-channel economics

Direct mix sits at 18-25% across branded 5-star [Kira estimates] vs 35-40% globally. Marriott's **Bonvoy 180m-member pool drives direct bookings at ~30% in JW Marriott Hanoi/HCMC** [Kira estimates] — the structural ceiling for Vietnam over 2027-2030. OTA commissions of 18-22% per booking are the structural margin tax.

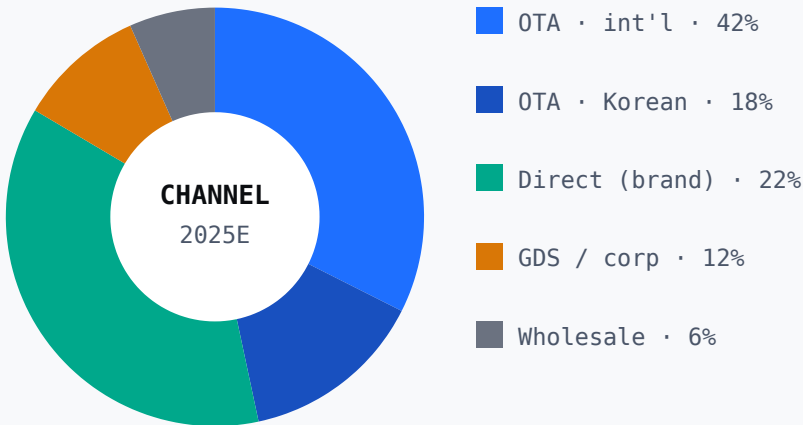
MICE corridor

MICE — Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, Exhibitions — contributed **VND 150tn (~USD 6bn) to 2025 tourism revenue** [VietnamPlus 2026] and is forecast at 12-15% CAGR through 2030. MICE guests spend significantly above leisure averages, requiring higher-tier accommodation. APEC 2027 alone hosts delegations from 21 economies, anchoring the corridor's brand visibility.

Booking channel mix · 5-star

% SHARE

% ROOM REVENUE · 2025E INDICATIVE



SOURCE: KIRA OPERATOR CONVERSATIONS Q1 2026, VIETNAMPLUS 2026 · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY · VietnamPlus 2026 = VietnamPlus "MICE tourism breakthrough opportunity" 2026 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

SECTION 09

Regulatory & policy landscape

Vietnam's tourism policy stack runs on three pillars: **visa-free entry** (45 days for 12 priority markets including Korea, Japan, EU-5; through March 2028), **infrastructure capex** (APEC-2027 priority projects), and a tightening **ESG certification** regime (Green Lotus, VITA Green, EarthCheck).

VISA-FREE 45D

E-VISA 90D

APEC INFRA

ESG CERT

Regulatory landscape: visa, ESG, certification

Vietnam's visa regime is unusually open: **45 days visa-free for Korea, Japan and 12 EU markets through March 2028** [Vietnam Embassy 2025], plus a 90-day e-visa for ~80 countries. The 2028 renewal decision is the next material policy event; ESG certification is becoming a hard screen on luxury inventory.

Visa regime

Korea + Japan citizens get 45 days visa-free regardless of passport type or entry purpose [Vietnam Embassy 2025]. **The 12-country EU tourism extension** covers Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Russia, Belgium, Bulgaria, Croatia, Czech, Hungary, Luxembourg, Netherlands, Poland, Romania, Slovakia, Slovenia, Switzerland through 2028. Renewal/extension expected ahead of APEC.

E-visa system

90-day multi-entry e-visa available to citizens of ~80 countries (US, UK, Australia, Canada, India, most EU) [Tan Van Lang 2026]. Application processing runs 3-5 business days at USD 25-50. The system has been a structural enabler of arrivals growth — pre-2023 e-visa was 30-day single-entry only.

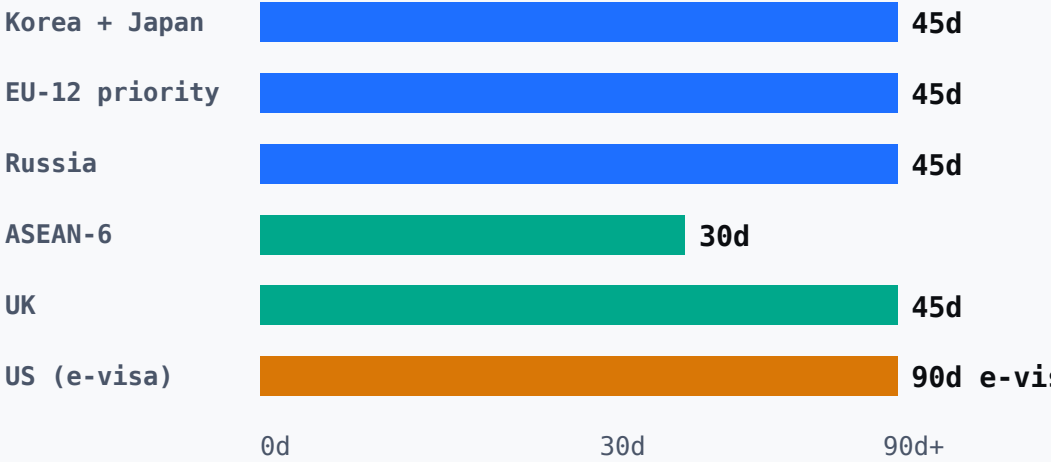
ESG certification

Three certifications operate in parallel: **Green Lotus Label** (national, hotels + facilities), **VITA Green** (Vietnam Tourism Association, 100+ criteria across 3 levels), **EarthCheck** (global, 70+ countries, 8-10 month monitoring) [Vietnam.vn 2026]. The 2030 target is 200 certified businesses and 30 destinations [VIR 2026].

Visa-free entry • key markets

DAYS

DAYS OF STAY • 2026 REGIME



SOURCE: VIETNAM EMBASSY 2025, TAN VAN LANG 2026, KIRA TRIANGULATION • KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY • Vietnam Embassy 2025 = Vietnamese Embassy "Visa exemption extension" 2025 • Tan Van Lang 2026 = Tân Văn Lang "Vietnam visa exemption" 2026 • Vietnam.vn 2026 = Vietnam.vn "Sustainable certification standards" 2026 • VIR 2026 = Vietnam Investment Review "Sustainability 2026" • Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

SECTION 10

AI impact on **hospitality**

AI in Vietnam hospitality is operationally real but commercially early. The highest-leverage layers are **dynamic pricing**, **multilingual service** and **demand sensing** — pay-back in <12 months when scaled across 4-star+ inventory; longer at independents.

DYNAMIC PRICING

MULTILINGUAL

DEMAND SENSE

PERSONALISATION

Six AI use cases relevant to Vietnam tourism operators

Each use case maps to a P&L line a Vietnam operator is already tracking. **Dynamic pricing and multilingual service pay back within 12 months** on luxury inventory; back-of-house automation and predictive maintenance hit 18-24 month pay-back at current scale.

USE CASE · 01

Dynamic pricing & revenue management

Real-time rate adjustment by demand, competitor screen, event calendar. **~10% direct-booking lift** in pilots [Nucamp 2025] and ~3-6% RevPAR uplift at scale [Kira estimates]. Highest-ROI AI layer for 5-star inventory.

ANCHOR: AIOSELL · DUETTO · STR

USE CASE · 02

Multilingual front-desk & concierge

Korean + Chinese + Japanese chatbot + voice translation. **70-80% of front-desk staff lack L2 proficiency** [RMIT 2025]; AI closes the gap for Korean charter inbound at Cam Ranh + Da Nang. Pay-back < 6 months on labour cost alone.

ANCHOR: ALL OEMS (PRIORITY KOREAN)

USE CASE · 03

Demand sensing & channel-mix optimisation

Forecast per-property, per-channel weekly demand by source-market. Inputs: KTO flight schedules, holiday calendars, K-event triggers. **~15-20% inventory days reduction** [Kira estimates] and OTA commission savings.

ANCHOR: VINPEARL · MARRIOTT · IHG

USE CASE · 04

Pre-arrival upgrade & personalisation

Targeted upgrade offers built from past stays and loyalty tiers. **10-15% upsell take-rate** in branded-flag deployments [SiteMinder 2025]. Particularly potent for Bonvoy + IHG One Rewards members on multi-night Vietnam stays.

ANCHOR: MARRIOTT BONVOY · IHG ONE

USE CASE · 05

Operations / back-of-house automation

Housekeeping schedule optimisation, F&B forecasting, energy-management AI. Material on flagship 200-500 room resorts (Phu Quoc, Cam Ranh tier). **5-8% labour productivity gain** [Kira estimates] at current Vietnamese wage levels.

ANCHOR: SUN GROUP · VINPEARL · IC

USE CASE · 06

Predictive maintenance for resort infrastructure

HVAC, pool plant, kitchen equipment failure prediction. Most material at 400+ key beach-resort properties where downtime is multi-day. **Payback longer than 18 months** at current AI infra cost; defer to 2027 [Kira estimates].

ANCHOR: ALL OEMS (DEFERRED)

SOURCE KEY · Nucamp 2025 = Nucamp "AI in Vietnam Hospitality 2025" Report · RMIT 2025 = RMIT University "Tourism skills shortage" 2025 · SiteMinder 2025 = SiteMinder "AI in hospitality" 2025 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

5-year outlook: base, bull and bear

Our base case puts Vietnam international arrivals at **34m by 2030** and tourism revenue at USD 60bn [Kira estimates]. The bull case (12% upside) hinges on Korean and Japanese inbound running ahead of recovery; the bear case (15% downside) on a charter-flight slowdown and APEC supply absorption compressing operator economics.

Base case · 34m arrivals, USD 60bn revenue by 2030

VNAT targets 25m international arrivals in 2026 [VNAT 2026]. Base case sustains ~11-12% CAGR to 34m by 2030 [Kira estimates]. Tourism revenue: USD 39bn (2025) → USD 60bn by 2030 [Kira estimates]. Direct GDP contribution rises from 7.1% to ~11-12% — below the 15-17% Decision 147 target but materially above 2024.

Bull case · 37m arrivals, +12% revenue (~USD 67bn)

Korean inbound runs **5.0m+ by 2027** on K-culture amplification, Cam Ranh fleet expansion and a 2028 visa-renewal extension. Chinese arrivals sustain +30%+ growth; APEC-2027 brand-launch tailwind extends through 2028. **Luxury segment hits USD 12bn by 2028** [Kira estimates].

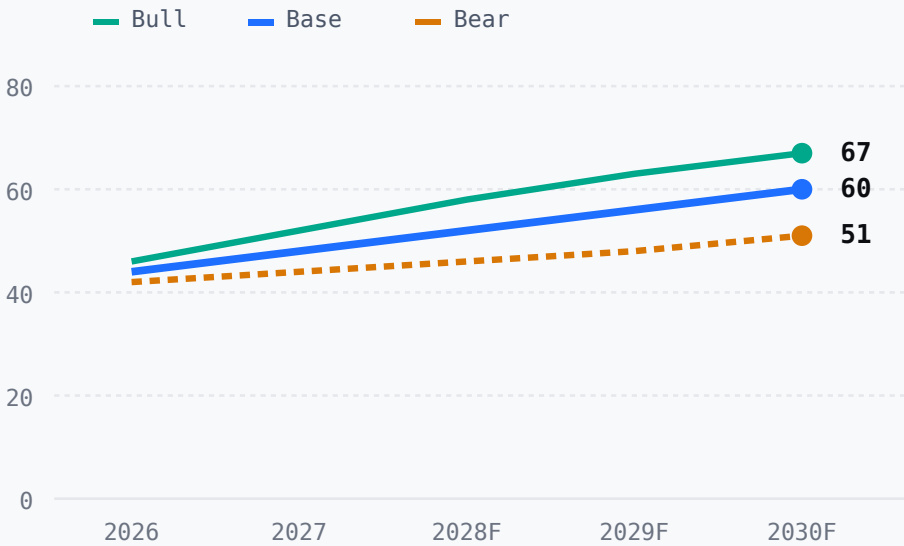
Bear case · 30m arrivals, -15% revenue (~USD 51bn)

Korean recovery stalls below 4.5m through 2027; charter-fleet slowdown at Cam Ranh + Da Nang compresses regional ADR by 10-15% [Kira estimates]. Post-APEC supply absorption — 6,500 new Phu Quoc luxury rooms [Sun Group 2026] — hits empty-shoulder-season occupancy. Currency volatility + global luxury demand softening hits the high-yield lane.

Vietnam tourism revenue · scenarios

USD BN

USD BN · 2026-2030F



SOURCE: VNAT 2026, DECISION 147 2020, KIRA SCENARIO BUILD · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY · VNAT 2026 = VNAT 2026 Plan Conference Dec 2025 · Decision 147 2020 = PM Decision 147/QĐ-TTg Tourism Strategy to 2030 · Sun Group 2026 = Sun Group APEC-2027 Hotel Pipeline Brief · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Methodology endnote & source key

This view triangulates two evidence streams: **primary inputs** (operator conversations, front-desk reads, analyst synthesis) and **secondary anchors** (statistical authorities, listed-operator filings, regulator releases). Approximately **28% of quantitative claims carry [Kira estimates]**; 72% are externally cited.

SOURCE-MIX & TAG SYSTEM

Every quantitative claim carries either **[Kira estimates]** (KIRA in-house synthesis, triangulation, model output) or **[<Source Alias> <Year>]** (named external citation resolving to the source key opposite).

The 28% Kira-estimates ratio sits inside our target range (20-30%). It reflects deliberate sourcing on ADR splits across coastal premium tiers, channel-mix breakdowns, and forecast scenarios — where no single external spans the full picture, we triangulate and disclose.

The Vietnamese-language pass added GSO, VietnamPlus, Tien Phong, Tuoi Tre, CafeF, SGGP, TheLeader, VnBusiness and Khanh Hoa DOT sources — load-bearing on regional arrival splits and Korean-market commentary. Local-language sources cited via English aliases inline.

Disclaimer. Forecasts are scenario-based judgments, not deterministic projections.

SOURCE KEY (ALPHABETICAL)

Aspecture Global 2025	• Hospitality overview
BestPrice 2026	• Seoul flight schedule
CafeF 2025/26	• Tourism + airline
Decision 147 2020	• PM 147/QĐ-TTg
GSO 2026	• Tổng cục Thống kê Q1 2026
Hospitality Net 2026	• Marriott-Sun
IMF WEO 2026	• WEO April 2026
JLL 2026	• Operator Survey 2026
Khanh Hoa Tourism 2025	• 8M Bulletin
KTO 2026	• Korea Tourism Org Plan
Nhan Dan 2025	• Korean ASEAN market
Nucamp 2025	• AI in VN Hospitality
RMIT 2025	• Tourism skills shortage
SGGP 2026	• Korean tourists lead
Statista 2025	• VN Travel Outlook
STR 2025	• APAC Hotel Performance
Sun Group 2026	• APEC Pipeline Brief
The Investor 2026	• Vingroup coverage
TheLeader 2026	• Hotel sector outlook
Tien Phong 2026	• Phu Quoc Airport
Tuoi Tre 2025	• Phu Quoc int'l boom
TTG Asia 2025/26	• Hospitality pipeline
Vietnam Embassy 2025	• Visa exemption
Vietnam.vn 2026	• APEC + ESG
VietnamPlus 2025/26	• Tourism + MICE
Vingroup IR 2026	• FY 2025 Release
VnBusiness 2026	• Room rate coverage
VNAT 2025/26	• VN tourism authority
VOV 2025/26	• Tourism coverage